Eric Zelman - **02:54**

Hey, how are you? Hi. Oh, okay. I'm about to talk to Brendan about my project. I'm just waiting for him to start a Zoom, this job finding platform that I'm writing. He's going to test it. I'm getting testers, people that tested one of the parts of it. So I have like a dozen people who are going to start testing it. Can I call you back later?

Brendan McCarthy - **03:24**

All right, bye.

Eric Zelman - **10:26**

American Rockets from American. Hello, Brendan.

Brendan McCarthy - **17:22**

Sorry I'm late.

Eric Zelman - **17:24**

No, sir, how are you? I. And if this is a bad time, like.

Brendan McCarthy - **17:29**

Oh, it's good. I knew it was going to be crappy weather today, and so today was the day, not yesterday, because yesterday was nicer weather and I had both work to do and tomorrow will be cold.

Eric Zelman - **17:43**

Yes. Did you get. Did you get outside today? Did you. Did you try to get some vitamin D?

Brendan McCarthy - **17:50**

No.

Eric Zelman - **17:51**

Oh, man. Perfect.

Brendan McCarthy - **17:54**

It's all good.

Eric Zelman - **17:56**

Okay,.

Brendan McCarthy - **17:59**

I'm.

Eric Zelman - **17:59**

I'm drinking my Guinness. Oh, it's not a proper Guinness, but it'll have to do.

Brendan McCarthy - **18:07**

I'll get a beer too, then. I own my own business. I can keep six pack under the desk.

Eric Zelman - **18:15**

You can you put it on top of the desk.

Brendan McCarthy - **18:19**

There's whiskey over there somewhere. Cheers.

Eric Zelman - **18:24**

All right, sir, let's get this. Let's get this going so you can go home.

Brendan McCarthy - **18:27**

Okay,.

Eric Zelman - **18:35**

So I've already given you the long, long ass diatribe about this.

Brendan McCarthy - **18:41**

Yeah. And I. And I read your document and I got my.

Eric Zelman - **18:45**

I got my provisional patent filed last week.

Brendan McCarthy - **18:48**

I know. Yeah.

Eric Zelman - **18:49**

So now that has like a 25 chance maybe of ever becoming real. But anyhow, here we are.

Brendan McCarthy - **18:58**

Okay.

Eric Zelman - **18:59**

Okay. So I'm. I'm asking you to help me validate the form that creates the lens document. Yep. So you're going to help me with a small part of what could be a much bigger project.

Brendan McCarthy - **19:15**

Okay.

Eric Zelman - **19:20**

You're going to gather material. So the best way to approach this, I think, is obviously a resume. But then if you have other things from other periods of your career, maybe you didn't, because I'm imagining you're not doing this at Crestar. Like peer reviews, management reviews, things that help and even. Not even necessarily work stuff that helps flesh out you. Right.

Brendan McCarthy - **19:52**

Yeah.

Eric Zelman - **19:52**

Now, tricky, but, yeah, this could be. This could be. For some people, this could be LinkedIn recommendations where they would.

Brendan McCarthy - **20:00**

I only have two, I think, and.

Eric Zelman - **20:03**

And you might, you know, take screenshots of those because I don't have a good way of importing LinkedIn. It doesn't let you do that easily. I'M I'm working. That's a future thing. But as much as you can provide. Yep. Right. Like I said to you at lunch one day, this could also be for some people, you know, like a video, like a YouTube that they, you know, of, or a video they upload or audio of a presentation or, you know, literally anything. And if it was Alyssa, it could be screenshots of her graphic design identity and work that she's done. So it doesn't actually even have to be text. So that's important to know. Like for instance, if you uploaded a bunch of pictures of you and your boat, that's good too.

Eric Zelman - **20:49**

I mean, all this kind of goes into fleshing out more about you and the more that you put in, the better the result.

Brendan McCarthy - **20:58**

Okay,.

Eric Zelman - **21:02**

So again, resume LinkedIn profile would be great. Writing samples, assessments, anything else, and buy anything. You know, I'm pretty liberal about that. I don't know that there is a limit. I haven't tested certain things, but you know, try it out. Like, I don't know if it'll work with video or audio, but I think other things will. Pictures and PDFs and stuff like that should be fine.

Brendan McCarthy - **21:24**

All right.

Eric Zelman - **21:25**

Okay, so I'm going to send you a link. I'm going to send you an email that has the steps of. And it's going to include a link to a form. The form is going to walk you through your professional identity, your work environment, your values and motivations, how you see leadership and val and collaboration. Yep, some of these titles are pretty fuzzy. So I mean, should this be a list of four things versus eight things? I don't know. But this is about that all together.

Brendan McCarthy - **21:58**

But that the book. What color is your parachute? I read it back in 94 before I moved to America. And that exactly that is this.

Eric Zelman - **22:06**

Brandon, you hit it on the head. And I can't use that term with anyone under the age of 50. But yes, that it was a bit religiosity too.

Brendan McCarthy - **22:14**

Actually, it's funny enough, I read it on Easter weekend before moving to America, which is a four day holiday in Europe. And yeah, it's a workbook and it's kind of a workbook book. And I read it over the like four days. Done.

Eric Zelman - **22:32**

Yeah. So I mean this isn't far from that. I mean that's much more developed. Right.

Brendan McCarthy - **22:37**

I mean that's a phenomenal book. And I think it still exists.

Eric Zelman - **22:42**

It does, I think just a little.

Brendan McCarthy - **22:44**

Bit too religious for Me, but.

Eric Zelman - **22:48**

So what this is going to do is, as I mentioned, is it's going to dump everything. Well, not in. It's going to parse everything and then it's going to structure everything into a document that has various sections that could then be used for matching against opportunities, but also it could be a personal briefing. Yeah. The easiest, simplest form right now for this is even if I don't have all the job stuff set up, this form, this file comes out, and then I send you back a formatted PDF that's human readable versus a text file, you know, that has. That's nice and summarized about these different aspects of you. At the end of this, there's a feedback form.

Brendan McCarthy - **23:37**

Yep.

Eric Zelman - **23:43**

So again, context is everything. You can go slow.

Brendan McCarthy - **23:49**

You're very thorough in your. I read your document. You were very thorough. It's like, whoa, this is amazing.

Eric Zelman - **23:54**

Well, I mean, I, I don't want to oversell me. I mean, half of this is like me working with AI to create these things. So the document is from a whole series of conversations, but I'm not sitting there actually writing all the documents.

Brendan McCarthy - **24:09**

Yeah, you're not. Who wrote AI?

Eric Zelman - **24:12**

Yeah.

Brendan McCarthy - **24:15**

Really?

Eric Zelman - **24:16**

Yes, yes.

Brendan McCarthy - **24:17**

And I notice you're using. You said you're using Claude. So you think Claude is better than Google Gemini?

Eric Zelman - **24:24**

I don't know that it's better. It's just that Claude is more. So Claude is better suited for doing coding for me. Now, that is not to say that people at Google probably have incredible tools that I don't understand because I'm not a developer, but I found that in working with Claude and they have a tool called Claude code versus just using the chatbot. It has a lot of really powerful, for me, development tools that are tied into it that make doing a project like this more doable. So, like, for instance, at a very superficial level, Gemini has a lot of advantages potentially in terms of integration into like Google's suite of products, Google Docs, Gmail maybe. Although Claude can access all my Gmail and all my Google stuff anyhow, so I don't really know.

Brendan McCarthy - **25:23**

I just think Gemini has access to all the search in Google and I've been very impressed with it. I've been using the Paid Edition now for six months or so. And I mean, I've had some fights and arguments with it, but yeah, and.

Eric Zelman - **25:41**

So I haven't, like, I don't. I think I've just invested most of my time into Anthropic's tool and that's why it's built in Claude, I'm pretty sure that this could be built using a different AI.

Brendan McCarthy - **25:54**

Oh, they're all similar. Like, it's just. It's just like there's nuances between them, I think.

Eric Zelman - **25:59**

Right.

Brendan McCarthy - **25:59**

It's curious that you pick Claude and you have more experience with it, I guess.

Eric Zelman - **26:03**

Well, so, I mean, part of it also is that what happens is that when you're doing a project like this and creating. So let me show you the. The chatbot. Right. So let's just jump out of this. So I think I showed you. I think I explained to you that all of my data goes into.

Brendan McCarthy - **26:22**

You didn't. You're using airtable.

Eric Zelman - **26:25**

I'm using airtable. And so it integrates with airtable. So what happens is that in my workflow, my lens gets used against dozens of venture capital sites that list all of their investments.

Brendan McCarthy - **26:39**

You didn't say all that. I didn't remember it being airtable. And I guess airtable is a bit like Microsoft SQL, except it's easy.

Eric Zelman - **26:46**

Well, and it's also really AI integrated much more than SQL. So I don't have to do very much in airtable. Like, I can tell Claude code that we're going to dump this table into information, into airtable, even if it's unstructured. And, and it will find a structure and a method for making it happen.

Brendan McCarthy - **27:04**

Wow. So designs the schema for you based on your goals.

Eric Zelman - **27:09**

Yeah, yeah, you can do that. And it also, it's in and of itself, airtable has its own AI engine that can work with other. That can work with OpenAI or Gemini or any of them, but they all kind of share a similar kind of core LLM architecture. And one of the things that I like about this is that, you know, I can interrogate this data via Claude so I can refactor my information. So what I was saying about this whole process is that, look, what you're going to create is going to. Let me just stop sharing this for a second and show you a different screen. So what you're going to create is going to. I'm going to make this really pretty quick and try not to make it too painful. It's going to look something at all.

Brendan McCarthy - **27:58**

I'm absolutely fascinated.

Eric Zelman - **28:00**

It's going to look something like this. So this is. This thing here.

Brendan McCarthy - **28:07**

You don't have any coding knowledge or do you?

Eric Zelman - **28:10**

I have some. Yeah, I definitely have some. About. About how workflows are structured and about best practices.

Brendan McCarthy - **28:18**

Okay.

Eric Zelman - **28:18**

So more from like a participant and a stakeholder point of view.

Brendan McCarthy - **28:25**

Or a product manager like me. Like, I mean, you tell them. Yeah, you tell them what you want logically.

Eric Zelman - **28:31**

Right, Right.

Brendan McCarthy - **28:31**

And I know all this code here. You didn't write that.

Eric Zelman - **28:35**

No. And this isn't actually the code. So what this is though, this is human readable, but it's just very long. So what this is that it's taking all the code, takes all the inputs, and then creates a structured document,.

Brendan McCarthy - **28:49**

HTML based or this is text.

Eric Zelman - **28:52**

This is all just text. It's in a format called markdown, but it's.

Brendan McCarthy - **28:55**

Oh, markdown. Okay, okay.

Eric Zelman - **28:59**

So what this is doing is that it's going through. This is a hypothetical person named Sarah. And what it did with Sarah is that it went in and has information about the kind of roles that she's interested in. Her career arc, what's important to her, what are positives and negatives for signals about evaluating fit. So for instance, mission positive things she's interested in working for products that improve daily work or daily life. Negative would be that if things are vague or generic. So there's all sorts of gates and values that go into what this file is about in terms of what this person wants, how much they want to make, need to make, where they're willing to live or not live. It can really be almost anything. Right.

Eric Zelman - **29:48**

So in this context, this is a document that reflects both where they have been in their career, but it's not a resume and also reflects what they're interested in terms of doing with their career going forward and what they're looking for.

Brendan McCarthy - **30:09**

Where I struggle, and it's probably because I'm 60 in May, is it's not. While it's a structured document, it sounds quite spongy and that my document might be structured differently.

Eric Zelman - **30:25**

Well, so in my system they're actually going to be structured the same way. But the information within those sections could be different. So for instance, they're going.

Brendan McCarthy - **30:33**

Data can be different, but that, but the structure is the same then. So you're really compiling the same. You're filling a form in basically you are absolutely. Okay.

Eric Zelman - **30:46**

You absolutely are. And that this is then. Then these wants, needs, skills are then weighed against a series of weights.

Brendan McCarthy - **30:57**

Yep.

Eric Zelman - **30:58**

So that you can evaluate things and say culture or role are more important to me than say work style or the mission of the company is the most important. So it's a score, it's a scoring system. And I have 100 again, what color is your parachute? This is exactly.

Brendan McCarthy - **31:15**

He went into things like what city do you want to live in, what is the kind of newspapers they have in. In Cleveland, Ohio.

Eric Zelman - **31:22**

Exactly.

Brendan McCarthy - **31:23**

Like the kinds of. Do you like the media? No, they're all gone. But like do you like that kind of. Yeah, yeah, exactly.

Eric Zelman - **31:32**

All of that, all of that is in here. And so like for instance, mission and sector down here. You know what are her strongest suits? Where does she want to work? Ed tech. Why? If some of these domains like her history, she was pre med before going into business. Med tech stretches that scratches that itch. And tech, her personal values. I mean so there's this whole narrative what stage of the company she want to work for A through C round maybe because she wants to work for early stage companies. So that's sort of taken off of what I was going after situation and timeline. Like ideal geography. How soon does she need a role? Is she doing this casually? Is this something in the background? Is she happy?

Eric Zelman - **32:14**

Is she going to use the tool and have this occasionally come back with things that are just really incredible things and otherwise just, you know, not much.

Brendan McCarthy - **32:21**

But you're relying on free text of her description. Like free text and then using large language models to interpret that free text to codify it somehow.

Eric Zelman - **32:36**

Exactly. So I'm looking at this from when you start the form, you're uploading a lot of documents about yourself

and then it's taking that into context, it's reading all of that and then it's working through those documents that you wrote to flesh everything else out in a conversation with you.

Brendan McCarthy - **32:54**

Fuck me. This is a long way from neuro linguistic nlp. It's a long way. This is cool. Good.

Eric Zelman - **33:02**

So, so what then happens with this lens? And in my case, you know, I built this whole follow up to the lens. So I have a document that's structured like this.

Brendan McCarthy - **33:13**

Yeah.

Eric Zelman - **33:14**

And then what happens is that in my. And this isn't what you're going to test, but this is sort of the sort of next step of this is that in my workflow I've got about 40, maybe 30 different VCs, about 4,000 at this point. 3, 500 Companies that then the. That then I have workflows that it, that I built that go through and parse each of these VCs, get all of their jobs and then interrogate them against a number of basically enrichment points.

Brendan McCarthy - **33:54**

Yep.

Eric Zelman - **33:54**

So, so what happens is that data comes in and it gets enriched by service. So I don't know if you have had to do this but there are enrichment services on the web, companies like Crunchbase or Brave. No idea what they do, what they. So so basically I'm building a big shovel. Right. And we're just putting a lot of. In the shovel.

Brendan McCarthy - **34:18**

Yep.

Eric Zelman - **34:19**

And so in my case, because I'm looking for early stage startups, the stuff that I'm putting in the shovel, right. So I'm, the shovel is, you know, I'm looking at the stuff in the shovel through the lens. But the shovel for in my case is a whole bunch of VCs and their investments and it's going through those companies using enrichment tools like Brave or Anthropic to look these companies up to figure out what they do, how much they're worth, when their funding rounds were. Right. Because if I'm going to work for an A round company, that's great. But if that A round was given to them in 2011 and they never got any money after 2011, they're done. They're stale, they're done.

Eric Zelman - **35:02**

I don't want to, I don't need to know about that and I don't want to go down that rabbit hole of investigating them. So there's a whole, there's a lot of logic that goes into evaluating what a company does. Are they, how fresh are they?

Brendan McCarthy - **35:17**

And you talked all that through with your AI, with Claude, you said, because they wouldn't know that you told it. No, no, I don't want them. Yeah, you created all that logic.

Eric Zelman - **35:30**

I created all this logic which is.

Brendan McCarthy - **35:33**

Really for you only, not for everyone.

Eric Zelman - **35:36**

Well, but now what I've done with it and what I started to do a couple months ago is said, okay, I need to make this modular so that if the person who wants to use this workflow is interested in working for a mid sized company or a large size company and you know, or they have a different feed or they're trying to solve a different problem entirely, that these sections are modules. So in other words, the data that the shovel has doesn't really matter. And so you could start to say, what if these were sections, for instance, about evaluating someone's fit instead of taking this as are my. A good fit for this are if I've got this big bucket of all these companies I'm interested in working for, how do I do this in reverse? Right.

Eric Zelman - **36:31**

How does that company build a lens to then evaluate potential candidates for a job?

Brendan McCarthy - **36:38**

So scary, man. So I told my team about this tonight because I couldn't get them to leave because it was raining and they didn't want to leave. And meantime they're hanging around on my dimension and I'm like, I turned the lights off because I just gotta. You gotta leave.

Eric Zelman - **36:52**

And I'm sorry. I apologize. We could. I did. I really appreciate you. I'm sorry.

Brendan McCarthy - **36:57**

No, no. But they all got grumpy. But, like, they were hanging around while being paid, right? Because they didn't want to leave because it was raining. And I'm like. So I turned the lights off because they weren't doing anything good. They were just around like, go home, go to the bar, do whatever. Like. Or clock out. And then you can. You can do like. But one of them said to me, when I tried to describe inadequately what you're doing, you know, they. They know about Personas because I. I insist. We have our marketing person, and we've had three marketing people so far. We. That we have Personas and that we write ads with Personas in mind. Now, whether they're doing it or not, I don't really know. But, like, there are specific kinds of people that come in this shop. So I'm going.

Brendan McCarthy - **37:54**

I bear with me here. They're like, could we use that. Your technology, to make our marketing more effective? I was like, no, this is about job search. But coming back to you, Eric, could we use your technology to sell?

Eric Zelman - **38:18**

So, well, let's. Let's get. So let's hold on to that for a moment. Let me just go through, because you.

Brendan McCarthy - **38:24**

Talked to me about the employer side, right, where they're trying to define a Persona they're looking for.

Eric Zelman - **38:31**

Exactly.

Brendan McCarthy - **38:32**

Okay, so think about that now. If you were in marketing and you had this tool to try and define. To help you define the people that you're selling to.

Eric Zelman - **38:46**

Yeah.

Brendan McCarthy - **38:47**

I mean, fast here.

Eric Zelman - **38:49**

Yeah. Well, so there are actually so, funny enough, there are sort of tools like that. So there's. There are. So, yes, there are tools like that. They are called. Well, they have various names, but they're sales enablement tools and marketing enablement tools. And in sales enablement, what they do is that you pay for. I mean, I've seen these over and over again. These definitely exist. So this architecture, in and of itself isn't. Not all of it is novel. And okay, so what happens is that, for instance, one company that this. There are a bunch of these. One company I was

talking to, it's a startup. Basically, he has 250 million he calls verified or quality leads.

Brendan McCarthy - **39:47**

Yep.

Eric Zelman - **39:48**

Right, 250 million leads. And what his AI does is basically take your product portfolio and let you have it, do the dialing for dollars. What people used to have, the junior salespeople Used to just call up leads and try to get them to the senior salespeople. This can all be done through AI now. And it does all those kinds of little. I don't know if I told you about it, but it's just all these really nice nuanced things. Like for instance, not that I think this is nice because I don't want to get spammed personally, but it's not.

Brendan McCarthy - **40:23**

Really that nice because I'm a business person and I'm getting these calls all the time and they're. And they're really low quality. If they're AI, they're not really.

Eric Zelman - **40:33**

Yeah, so your mileage will vary and the quality of things will vary. But I'm just saying that idea exists. That idea exists.

Brendan McCarthy - **40:44**

So some of this here, which to me is novelty, is you building on your domain knowledge of your whole career.

Eric Zelman - **40:53**

Right? Yeah. So. So with this. So for instance, what I have here, for instance, the things are important to me is that it isn't just finding the company and just scraping all the companies from the venture firms and figuring out which venture firms I should even look at to begin with and figuring out what series of investment they have. And have AI give me some sort of summaries of should I apply, should I disqualify them based on my gates and scoring, but also understanding what kind of product they have. Like when they go to market, are they talking about enterprise

technology, are they talking about small, medium business or mid market summaries? Employee count.

Brendan McCarthy - **41:34**

Right.

Eric Zelman - **41:34**

This all goes into it. I want to know that kind of information. I want to know when they were founded. But other things like for instance, for me this is really important. I know it's way off here in another column, but for instance, a customer Persona, if I'm going to be your support person or your customer success person, I have to understand the Persona of my customer.

Brendan McCarthy - **41:56**

Absolutely. Yeah. So.

Eric Zelman - **41:58**

So for me, I'm used to working with business users. I can work with developers, but it's not my preference. So a developer as the end user is not someone who I have deep experience with. I could extend this out to have various other Personas that I don't work with. For instance, okay, so I could also say likewise that I'm. That if the Persona is healthcare, life, science lab manager. Right. That's not a customer that I'm used to supporting. Right. I'm also not used to supporting someone in, you know, manufacturing, logistics. I mean, so customer Persona becomes a very important thing for me. Thinking about what's going to be a good fit for a company when they're selling a product and am I a good fit for their go to market team?

Eric Zelman - **42:47**

Because I need to know what they're selling and whether that's a customer that I actually know how to work with.

Brendan McCarthy - **42:52**

That's very interesting.

Eric Zelman - **42:54**

And all of this comes through those, the logic of all these multiple points of data enrichment, either through services that I'm paying for. Well, they're all service. I put, none of this is free, but either through AI like Claude or through other services that just do data enrichment. These, these companies that just have hundreds of millions of data points about millions of companies and you can query them and you know, take that. And sometimes I actually go a step further and I even fact check those things because sometimes that information is wrong and I need to so process. Any one of these companies might take, you know, a couple of minutes, five minutes, you know, depending on how much you pay and you know, speed is everything. But anyhow, so what you're going to get, what I'm asking you to test.

Brendan McCarthy - **43:47**

Yep.

Eric Zelman - **43:47**

Is, is this. So this is the intake form.

Brendan McCarthy - **43:51**

Okay.

Eric Zelman - **43:52**

So the intake form in and of itself will take about 25 to 45 minutes.

Brendan McCarthy - **43:58**

All right.

Eric Zelman - **43:58**

I mean, yeah, you could blow through it faster, but I know you want products.

Brendan McCarthy - **44:04**

Yeah, I think that my last, I just looked it up. My last job application was April 15, 2019. So we can use that resume. It's fucking hell.

Eric Zelman - **44:16**

But you know, you could also put in there. I mean, seriously, it's like I would put in like, okay, do you have marketing materials about Crest Star? I mean, you're going to tell it, I own Crest Star. This is my company. So the more you tell it about Crest Star, the more it knows about you. Okay, right. The more you tell it about boating, the more you tell it about, I don't know, you know, the, all these things kind of go in there. Your style of how you like to work.

Brendan McCarthy - **44:46**

Right.

Eric Zelman - **44:49**

So these, these buckets are kind of vague. I mean, there's four boxes. I honestly, to be quite honest, think you could put, I, I don't know, you could probably put the resume into any one of these boxes and it would probably still work. But this is just how it laid it out for me.

Brendan McCarthy - **45:03**

Okay.

Eric Zelman - **45:04**

I think they all do the same thing. I'm just saying I don't, I haven't tested it. It's going to say, are you employed, Are you actively searching or are you in transition? So I think that also helps it to shape the urgency of what you're trying to do. Right, because do you want me to.

Brendan McCarthy - **45:18**

Say that I own Crestar and I'm not. I'm not looking for work right now, or do you want me to pretend?

Eric Zelman - **45:24**

No. Yeah, because, like, when you say you're employed, that means you're not actively looking. Right. And it's. And it. And it's going to have a slight inflection on how it asks you questions.

Brendan McCarthy - **45:34**

And you want that.

Eric Zelman - **45:35**

I want that. It's also not scripted. I mean, this is a 1.0 going against a large language model, so everyone's experience is going to be a little bit different. What I'm building here in the background are. Are a series of text files that can behave as guardrails. So, for instance, in early versions earlier that you don't have here, this would go on and on. So, like, okay, this can't go on forever. This isn't meant to be a psychotherapist. There's this whole propensity of chatbots. They have no concept of time. Right.

Brendan McCarthy - **46:10**

So, yeah, and they always end with the question, like, do you want me to. You want me to do more for you?

Eric Zelman - **46:16**

Yeah, exactly. And this is.

Brendan McCarthy - **46:18**

I. I've learned over a long time now to just be like.

Eric Zelman - **46:23**

And.

Brendan McCarthy - **46:23**

And if I haven't hurt their feelings. So they don't have any feelings. It's a photocopier.

Eric Zelman - **46:28**

Exactly. So this is just a proof of concept. And so if. So, you know, I'm just saying, Brendan, if you start putting in questions about if my boat weighs this much, how much water will it displace? It'll probably answer all those questions too, because it's not, you know, I've. I've put it actually in there before because I played around with other chat bots where I put in nonsense things just to, like, get, you know, because, like, I was. I did think it's funny that you can go to anyone's chat bot, like, even, you know, like the chat bot on, like, the AT&T site, and have it help you do your taxes, because.

Brendan McCarthy - **46:58**

No, you have. That's funny.

Eric Zelman - **47:01**

Yeah, well, I didn't literally do that one, but I did something similar on a job site, one of the competitors, or I was looking at people who have technology similar to this or adjacent to this, and I was like, well, what happens if I. If I put in, you know, hey, you know, I'm looking for this job, but before we get on to this next opportunity that you think I Should look at. In your list of jobs, could you help me understand Pythagoras theorem? You know, like, so they'll go sideways quickly. And I'm trying to build guardrails so that it's a little more focused.

Brendan McCarthy - **47:31**

Are you familiar with there's a podcast called Shell Game?

Eric Zelman - **47:38**

No.

Brendan McCarthy - **47:39**

So he started off with. He got a large language model and he hooked it up to a telephone and he copied his voice and he had it go out and interview people and piss them all off. And. And then he went off and he cloned it and had it talk to itself and create hilarious results. And. And now he's in his third season. He's building a company. Entirely populated with bots.

Eric Zelman - **48:23**

You. You.

Brendan McCarthy - **48:23**

Well, that.

Eric Zelman - **48:24**

That's a. Sir, that's a thing. So do you know that there's a. You know, like humans use things like Reddit or, you know, for discussion or whatever. This. There's this guy, these people who last year developed a site called Molt Book. M O L T B O O K. So imagine if Reddit had no human beings, and what it was an open forum for bots to talk to each other. So Molt Book was bought by Facebook, by Meta.

Brendan McCarthy - **48:58**

M O L T B O L.

Eric Zelman - **48:59**

K M O L T B O. Okay. Yeah. Molt Book.

Brendan McCarthy - **49:06**

Okay. And it got bought by Facebook.

Eric Zelman - **49:11**

Yeah, for like $500 million.

Brendan McCarthy - **49:14**

Jesus. For what?

Eric Zelman - **49:19**

Well, so I think that the. I think that the thinking is that it's a way of having bots train each other.

Brendan McCarthy - **49:27**

Right, Right. Yeah.

Eric Zelman - **49:29**

And so. And so it. Or I mean, or it's like, you know, it's a synthetic environment. Right. It's like, it's like when people do betting, modeling. Right. Like what? You know, since you left gambling. Right. Like the thing. I think that. I don't know that, like IGT or those companies, I'm sure they're aware of all of this. Is this thing called Polymarket.

Brendan McCarthy - **49:57**

I'm not.

Eric Zelman - **49:58**

So Polymarket is basically this. This.

Brendan McCarthy - **50:02**

The futures market.

Eric Zelman - **50:05**

Well, in with. So poly. Let me.

Brendan McCarthy - **50:09**

Where you start. Were you betting on politics and sports?

Eric Zelman - **50:11**

But Poly Market is a prediction market.

Brendan McCarthy - **50:13**

Yeah, yeah, I've heard about an npr. Yeah. And it's basically, you can bet on anything. It's done on the futures, commodities markets out of Chicago or someplace. And you can bet on anything.

Eric Zelman - **50:26**

Yeah, exactly.

Brendan McCarthy - **50:28**

And I'm a huge believer in betting on anything because when I look up the American presidential elections and things, I look at it from the Paddy Powers website in Ireland, like, who. Who's betting on what? And I'VE been doing this for 10 years. I'm going to see the odds change. I mean, the group thought an economist will confirm this is better than some hunch, right?

Eric Zelman - **50:53**

So what I think, what I think the blurring point for me is right now is that just like Reddit is a surface for ideas to be formed and propagated by people, right? Imagine that instead of it just being a forum, imagine that Reddit is really just like a field of just tilled soil where they can grow shit, right? And polymarket is basically a forum where people can basically create bets and propagate those and test out theories. And in AI, there's things like Moat Book and there's also things like orchestration layers where people can have bots interact with each other and it creates a surface and a space, a virtual place for these things to actually interact and work together and all of these things for them to work. Just like Reddit has terms and conditions, they all have this idea of a governance layer.

Eric Zelman - **52:05**

And so there are now companies, and there'll be large companies like Microsoft and Oracle who get into this, who are creating these kinds of governance layers that are going to say things like, if you want to use AI in your company, here's what it can do and can't do, here's where information can and can't go. If it's, you know, say, like, for instance, we have to. The data has to stay in the eu or we don't want, you know, so there's all these boundaries I guess I'm getting at here, and we're trying to loop this back to our conversation, is that I don't. I have some boundaries. You might. Your mileage will vary depending on what you put in.

Brendan McCarthy - **52:43**

Yeah, yeah, yeah, of course. So, so I'm dealing with these things all the time. I'm grand with saying, yeah, I'm done.

Eric Zelman - **52:49**

Yeah, yeah. So if your career was about like porn, you know, I don't know what the result is going to be from this. Okay, so then what happens?

Brendan McCarthy - **53:00**

Because, yeah, so then you're going to.

Eric Zelman - **53:02**

Go through a discovery. It's discovery, but eight sections. And then, and then, you know, it's going to kick off the chatbot, right now, I didn't upload, so this is without context. So when you start after you've uploaded things, this first introductory sentence at beginning conversation, it's going to know a fair amount about you to begin with, and it's going to guide that through the conversation. And it's going to go all the way to the end, which I don't have a slide of, but. And it will create a file that I will receive and that you should also get. I think it lets you download it at the end. As I said.

Brendan McCarthy - **53:43**

Eric.

Eric Zelman - **53:45**

Sorry.

Brendan McCarthy - **53:45**

It's very intimate.

Eric Zelman - **53:48**

We'll see. What I was saying before is that I can envision at some point in the future of this product that maybe it helps in the background scrape jobs or find opportunities for people. Maybe it gives them a report on a weekly or daily basis of things that they should apply for based on their scoring. I also would say that the next step for this might be a. To deliver a polished or more polished PDF file. So it might look something like this.

Brendan McCarthy - **54:26**

Render it out for a person. Yeah, yeah.

Eric Zelman - **54:28**

Instead of being. So this is like that woman Sarah, right?

Brendan McCarthy - **54:31**

Instead of seeing all that text, obviously easy to do.

Eric Zelman - **54:34**

Yeah, yeah, yeah. So it's gonna be. It's the structured document then becomes a PDF or a report or something. And, and you know, and maybe at some dumb level it's like, okay, here's my credit report, right? This is instead of a credit report. I get this, right. It's not that much different. So for right now though, without getting too far ahead of myself, that's what I want you to test. I want you to test the intake form.

Brendan McCarthy - **55:01**

All right.

Eric Zelman - **55:06**

My father in law knows the. So my father. This is, this is a random story, but it's pretty. But I think it's, it'll be interesting to talk to her. You know, he lives in Florida. He lives in, you know, wealthy retirement. Not retirement, but gated community. And one of their friends there is a woman named Edith, always a good name. And Edith Hunt. Turns out that she ran recruiting for Goldman Sachs for 32 years until 2013.

Brendan McCarthy - **55:37**

Wow.

Eric Zelman - **55:38**

Yeah. So he got me in touch with her and I'm going to speak to her next week about this. She's. Now she's. Edie is I'm guessing at least 75 years old. And so she has fortunately, hopefully missed all of the. Of AI recruiting and all this stuff. So she's out of the space. She's been out of the space for over a decade. But I think that it's going to be really fascinating to talk to her about some of my assumptions and understanding what her priorities are. Because I think that from the company side, what I really need to understand is do companies give a shit about having tools to prevent bad hires?

Brendan McCarthy - **56:21**

You should almost fly down to see her. She has been in the workforce till 10 years ago, 2016. So she's familiar with PCs and computing and everything. And the large language models are very novel. Still, until two, three years ago, everything was the same. She's. She's a gold mine.

Eric Zelman - **56:43**

I think she would be. And so I'm going to talk to her on Tuesday. And then another cheap.

Brendan McCarthy - **56:50**

You can pop down there and they're back in a day. I know you're unemployed, but good God, this is. That's cool.

Eric Zelman - **56:58**

So then my coach, the guy in Scunthorpe. Yeah. His take on it is that he thinks that this could be an interesting tool for some people. His, his, the, his big sort of take. The big takeaway I got from him, he's super nice guy. But is that. Look, his customers, his other clients are telling him that they're not even spending any time worrying about Matt hires. Like, it might be a slap on the wrist, but the market has so many people looking for jobs. If they don't make a good hire, it's so easy for them to replace them that they're willing to take their. Willing. They spend less. I mean, this is discouraging for me because I'm having such a hard time finding a job, but they're not spending that much effort on vetting people.

Brendan McCarthy - **57:48**

Is that in America or in Europe as Well?

Eric Zelman - **57:51**

In the U.S. okay.

Brendan McCarthy - **57:53**

Because in Europe there's consequences when you hire someone, you, you have to get rid of them within a couple of months or you own them and you only see of dismissing them.

Eric Zelman - **58:04**

So.

Brendan McCarthy - **58:04**

And I, I've always felt that's a very irresponsible approach in America where you just cavalierly hire people and it, if they're, if they don't work out, fire them.

Eric Zelman - **58:13**

I think. I know.

Brendan McCarthy - **58:14**

Very irresponsible. Because they may be quitting a job to come to you. I think it's a really very. I, I think that's. I, I wouldn't want to work for that person.

Eric Zelman - **58:25**

No, no, I agree. And we, I think. Yeah. And I don't think that reflects how he operates in the world.

Brendan McCarthy - **58:30**

No, no. I wasn't suggesting that for a second, but it, but it's discouraging to hear that he thinks that's the way it is. And I also been reading a lot of late, like if there's an employment implosion due to AI replacing people, which sounds like there might be. There's going to be lots of people unemployed.

Eric Zelman - **58:51**

Yeah. There's going to be a Ton of people unemployed.

Brendan McCarthy - **58:54**

Yeah.

Eric Zelman - **58:55**

I mean, you know, and I'm just the tip of the iceberg here.

Brendan McCarthy - **58:59**

Yeah.

Eric Zelman - **59:00**

So. But what, you know, I, I just wonder, is there a moment in between here? I don't know if I have a good slide for this. Where. Yeah, here's a. I'll just show you this because we're.

Brendan McCarthy - **59:16**

Well, you should listen to this podcast. You really should, because it's very funny. I mean, it's laughing out loud shell game.

Eric Zelman - **59:23**

I will, I will. I'll totally check it out. So here's, you know, here's one of those things where like for instance,.

Brendan McCarthy - **59:32**

In.

Eric Zelman - **59:32**

Looking at what I was doing, right, so this thing here, this bidirectional,.

Brendan McCarthy - **59:38**

I can't zoom out and I'm not able to zoom out. What's going on?

Eric Zelman - **59:41**

Oh, sorry. Did I screw it up?

Brendan McCarthy - **59:43**

No, no, you didn't. I was zoomed in earlier for something. I got it now. I got it. I'm good.

Eric Zelman - **59:47**

Okay. Is that good score?

Brendan McCarthy - **59:50**

Yeah.

Eric Zelman - **59:51**

This is what the patent is about. Yeah, it's this, it's the lens matching. It's this idea of does the candidate fit the role? Do we fit the candidate?

Brendan McCarthy - **01:00:03**

Yep.

Eric Zelman - **01:00:04**

And, and the scoring took that.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:00:07**

Away from our conversation. Yeah, yeah, that. And you're double selling there. You're selling to clients and selling to employers. You're selling to everybody. It's nice.

Eric Zelman - **01:00:15**

And then thinking about the marketplace. Right. Like, thinking about, you know, like ats. Right. So ATS is the majority of how you apply for a job through these sites like Greenhouse or Lever or Ashby or Rippling. I mean, I think I mentioned this kid who used to work for me at Harvard is the CEO of Rippling. Rippling is a like a billion doll, right, that does HR systems. And, and so I would say that 10, 15% of all the resumes I've sent go into their systems and people, you know, to SaaS service. And your company just pays Rippling to host its job. Rex. The point being is

they all use that automatic text scoring system. So it's this bingo system and none of them really seem to have any kind of backend deeper match. Everything is very surface.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:01:08**

Yeah. And so rippling 2.0. Basically. Yeah.

Eric Zelman - **01:01:11**

Yeah, yeah. So, so what. What's happened or what. Where. Why this thing seems relevant is that, you know, even I've been playing around with this company, Jack and Jill, they have they're a UK London based startup. They've got a really cool. I Mean, I found some jobs for myself. There's. They have over 14 million jobs that they claim to have access to, or tens of millions of jobs. And they have a really great UI chatbot and it's got $20 million in funding recently. So, I mean, they have a real team and it's really, it's amazing. And they have some of the things that I can do, right? Like they have, they learn your profile, like what you want or don't want. Like, you know, I mean, it does a lot of things, but it isn't really the same thing as what I'm doing.

Eric Zelman - **01:02:01**

Like, it's still more surface, it's better than ats, but it isn't the same thing. And you know, again, I, they might, that might be completely intentional. I mean, they've been at it. Obviously it isn't just one guy sitting in Rhode Island. I mean, they have people working on this and actual, you know, customers and so on and so forth. So, I mean, I have a lot of questions about how this sort of goes from here. But yeah, I mean, what I was going to say is that I think for now just, I just need to validate the plan is just to validate the intake.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:02:35**

Okay. Patents are a big deal and well, they may be discounting them, saying people just cheat anyway, but. No, patents are a really big deal and Well, I mean, it, you know,.

Eric Zelman - **01:02:50**

I, I mean, again, I, I, it, I'm just learning from a chatbot. So it's like it could be that what I bought, what, 65, 200, whatever it was, you know, is for not. And that if it really came to bear that, you know, someone would steamroll over me. But hopefully, you know, it's something that is true maybe. And, you know, and that there's a 25 or 30% chance that this is a real thing. I mean, I remember at Big Tin can, right, that we tried, or David, the founder, tried to patent some amount of the content delivery system that it used, right. This idea of the right content for a particular user delivered to them at the right time.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:03:36**

Right.

Eric Zelman - **01:03:38**

The patent was more elaborate than that, but it was something that took an incredible amount of money to get down the road. And I don't really know how much of that ever really ended up panning out. And I'm not really sure in the end also that doesn't necessarily save your company. Now, Big Tin can was around for, you know, 13 years until it was bought or sold to PE. So, I mean, That's. That's fine. Right.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:04:04**

But the patents may have helped with the valuation of the company.

Eric Zelman - **01:04:08**

It might have. Might have. So I'm gonna.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:04:11**

I know with IGT, our competitor at GTech who bought IGT ultimately, like, they. They own the slot machine patent for poker machines and they all. They own a bunch of patents like that and that. But that one was fundamentally phenomenal. And they made so much money off that one.

Eric Zelman - **01:04:32**

Yeah, yeah.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:04:32**

They made a bunch of others, like they had the patent for credit for. For. For dollar. Dollar bills in. Instead of coin in and take it out. Coin in bill and take it out. They had the patent on that. Like, holy. So every casino, every. No, Every slot machine manufacturer had to pay them to. To have.

Eric Zelman - **01:05:00**

Right.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:05:01**

That in their system. Like blood.

Eric Zelman - **01:05:03**

Yeah. So my thinking is that if Jack and Jill are one of these companies that's actually funded, goes down the road of saying that they want to start doing scored calibrated user or job seeker company matching.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:05:29**

Yep.

Eric Zelman - **01:05:29**

And that, you know, that. That I have some ground. But again, am I going to go and sue? Am I going to just sit on this and go, you know, if I got a patent, like, just wait for someone else to try to infringe on my patent? You know, it's not quite like that either. Like, you know, like, you can be a patent troll. Right. So I did it, and I'm proud I took that step. But I think that the. I think, you know, it's like that's. That's then. And you know, I have the rest of this year to try to bolster because it's a provisional. So I have the rest of this year to try to make something of this tool to bolster the validity of that. And eventually,.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:06:08**

If.

Eric Zelman - **01:06:08**

If I ever got down that road, I'd have to have some money to engage with an actual patent attorney because, you know, the DIY part is just such a tiny part of it and there's a longer road ahead. But I was excited. But I am really excited I did that. So.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:06:25**

Yeah. For you and decided to be your friends and like, wow. My friend did a patent. Like, whoa.

Eric Zelman - **01:06:33**

Anyhow, so, yeah, if you get. If you get time in the next week, that would be awesome. I'll bug you. I'll bug you in a week.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:06:41**

Okay. I was gonna do it now, but. Okay.

Eric Zelman - **01:06:46**

All right. Whatever you want.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:06:48**

I can start an interruption.

Eric Zelman - **01:06:50**

So I would say this, that what I've seen it says that it thinks it should. I had this conversation with it about safe states. It Might work. But I would say just what I would do is leave it open as a tab, as a bookmark tab. You know, in your browser you do.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:07:09**

That all the time. Because I think bookmarks open.

Eric Zelman - **01:07:15**

So I worry, I, I worry that it might lose its state.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:07:22**

It will.

Eric Zelman - **01:07:24**

I think it's, I think the state is in the browser cache. But.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:07:28**

And I think that's a vulnerability that you'll need to solve because.

Eric Zelman - **01:07:35**

Oh yeah, no, I, it's get interrupted in life. Right. So I, I hate to sound vague. It's either solved in the build that you have or it'll be solved in the next version.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:07:44**

Okay, so it's. So it's. You're already thinking about it?

Eric Zelman - **01:07:47**

Yeah, yeah. No, no, that, that's there. The idea of saving state and the next step would also that I think will logically come of this is okay, like what if I had 10 things now? But I think I'm going to come back. I want to come back to this after I even produce the document. How do I have to do it all over again? And so that's the next round of a methodology so that someone can iterate they've created.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:08:12**

Right, right.

Eric Zelman - **01:08:13**

Because it's going to change. They're going to want to add, they're going to want to have second thoughts or context changes. Right. I mean, so this all has to grow into something.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:08:22**

You met a girlfriend and she's from Ohio and then want to move to Ohio.

Eric Zelman - **01:08:27**

Right. So I have another build. I mean I didn't go. Because we could be on the phone all day where you can actually use your profile to sliders.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:08:38**

She, she got a lovely accent. Yeah.

Eric Zelman - **01:08:41**

No, but in this weird Tinder for jobs that you'd be able to like kind of like people use AI, I guess people I assume use AI filters for their dating profiles like you could use. So I have this other idea, I think I told you about this last week. It's a little abstract of this idea of focal length and aperture because it's a lens.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:09:06**

So. Yeah, you did.

Eric Zelman - **01:09:07**

Right. So. So some people want to see all the jobs. They want a wide angle lens, they want to see all the possibilities. Right. And some people want to get very, very myopic and very. And, and just see a very narrow range of things. And then some people want to be able to see deep within a company, really do deep interrogation. And some people are. Want something like focal or like aperture, something that's more shallow and some amount of that play. I'm not saying it'll work that way but there'll be some amount of play for people to make adjustments. Because I don't really think that people. That none of this isn't an exact science. I'm not trying to make this into this Woo. Kind of like literally.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:09:51**

Yeah, no, it's. And that's where I asked you the spongy question earlier. Like it's not exact. And creating forms that are structured and are consistent from person to person and or job to job and at the same time creating the flexibility for people to be. I met a girl in Ohio. Like yeah, that's hard because people, especially early in their career people do make changes and change based on the girl in Ohio.

Eric Zelman - **01:10:22**

Like exactly. I mean that's why the example document, I mean I show really briefly but that this, you know, example person, Sarah, right. She's like, talks about her hybrid work style, what she wants right now but it talks about situation, timeline, like what's her status? She's in transition, she's looking for the right opportunity but she's comfortable for the next five to six months. She's selective, not desperate. She has some geography she's interested in. Talks about how she's open to relocate for the right opportunity. Her spouse works remotely, she has two school age kids. She prefers not to move mid year before June or after August. I mean that can't fit in a resume.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:11:05**

No, but those. Oh my God. I was a recruiter in New York in 96 and I remember I had a candidate for a job, it was a hundred thousand dollar job at the time for a software developer. And he's like I have two kids and these are my

doctors. Does their health care system support these doctors? They didn't. He's like I'm out.

Eric Zelman - **01:11:33**

Yeah. And, and you know, I was talking with them,.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:11:37**

I lost $20,000. He's like no, I'm. I love you Brendan, but I'm out. I'm not, I'm not going to sign up with them because I need dolls that pediatrician or nothing.

Eric Zelman - **01:11:49**

Well no, and then, and I hear what you're saying but I think also that like it's sort of related to this thing that my former coworker Lewis was telling me. I was talking to him earlier this afternoon and Lewis is just, you know, like, you know so many people do these whole forms as gaming the system. Right. Like it's like when you do a workplace assessment about how Brendan is a manager while you're working for IGT or gtech, you're going to come out as alpha, Brendan. You're not going to come out with all your insecurities when you do that. When you do. Right. So when you do that assessment and you're me and you're unemployed, try to figure out what's next in your life, it's a very different. It's a different response. And.

Eric Zelman - **01:12:30**

But, you know, my thinking is that again, the more you add to this, the more you get to that. That marketing idea ahead of like the indelible Brandon, the indelible Eric. Not the. Not the. The one who's keyword matching his resume for the ATS system. Not the one who's gaming the answers to. Sound like, you know, that you're the decisive always, you know, run with your gut. Alpha manager or whatever that's supposed to be. Whatever you know, whatever you think they want to hear. And that's. And I think that that blended profile is really the what this kind of hopes to. To get at a little bit more.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:13:14**

Okay, cool. All right, let's go.

Eric Zelman - **01:13:20**

All right, I'm gonna go eat dinner. Thank you for your time. I'm gonna let you eat too and get the hell out of there.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:13:26**

Yeah, I'm normally here till this time every day, so she hasn't called. She's probably asleep. All good.

Eric Zelman - **01:13:36**

I bugged her too, because it's been.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:13:37**

A week, so I was like, she'll be harder to. Yeah, yeah. Keep pulling on.

Eric Zelman - **01:13:52**

Well, I appreciate your help.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:13:54**

She's a different person. Yeah, you're awesome. I gotta go.

Eric Zelman - **01:13:58**

Bye, man.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:13:59**

And so I got my hope. So you. You already sent me the link, right? It's in the email.

Eric Zelman - **01:14:06**

I. I will send it to you right now. No, no, you sent me an email.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:14:10**

A few days ago, didn't you, that had a link to the. To the form.

Eric Zelman - **01:14:15**

I think I did. Today I added the one.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:14:18**

The one that I read. The document that I read. I mean, there was an email.

Eric Zelman - **01:14:20**

Yeah, yeah. You have it.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:14:22**

Yeah. Testing. Yeah, so I got it. So, yeah, I could have just done it, but I didn't. So, yeah, click on that. There it is. Build your lens. Blah, blah. What's the same. Get started. Press that button. The red orange button. Did you pick that color on purpose?

Eric Zelman - **01:14:42**

Yeah. I feel like for doing this prototype, I just feel like the classic black text with red. It's very readable and it's just a classic graphic design theme. Can all change.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:14:59**

That's cool. We use this very similar color in our website for shopping. There's no. Once I clicked on it, there's no, like, save. Yeah, there's no save or. Oh, there's a. Oh, there's a back. There's the back. Yeah. Once you say get started. Oh, oh. So. Okay, I should share. You gotta give it up.

Eric Zelman - **01:15:37**

Yeah.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:15:38**

Okay, you see my screen? Which one I gotta share again.

Eric Zelman - **01:15:44**

Yeah, I think I gave you permission. Now you just point what screen you want share.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:15:49**

Come on. But the screen here, we see this screen.

Eric Zelman - **01:15:52**

Yeah.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:15:53**

Okay, so just react. This is very. Just reaction. Okay, so I'll close that. I'm gonna. I'm just gonna go. Okay. Click. Okay. Yeah, I. I immediately. I didn't see all this, and I saw it and I read it earlier, but today I just went get started

and.

Eric Zelman - **01:16:23**

But that. That's okay because, you know, it.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:16:27**

I missed all this stuff up here and I'm like, oh, yeah, this is different. Something's different down here than it was the first time I did it. But it was. I was focused on this orange button instead of focusing on the homework up here.

Eric Zelman - **01:16:39**

Okay.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:16:42**

It didn't draw my attention to. Because that was like, okay, boom, let's go. And it was in here already. And then I was like, wait a second. And then the back button is very vague. And I was like, there's no getting out of this. So actually, I think you need call to action buttons. Well, the first call to action is this. You need a call to action button. This needs to browse or something needs to be stronger here. You with me or. Yeah, on the left to say, hey, focus up here first.

Eric Zelman - **01:17:21**

Right.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:17:22**

Don't. Don't go. Don't go looking at this button yet because you're not there.

Eric Zelman - **01:17:26**

Right.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:17:27**

Just plumbing. It's not. This is easy stuff. But that's the first reaction. Okay. I don't know if it would help. I don't know if I can capture all. I. I guess I can. I can do an audio as I go.

Eric Zelman - **01:17:43**

Yeah, if you do an. I mean, if. If you. I mean, I can do.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:17:48**

I can do a dictation to a phone.

Eric Zelman - **01:17:50**

Oh, my God, that would be amazing.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:17:52**

Yeah.

Eric Zelman - **01:17:52**

Yeah, I will. I will feed all this. This stuff in for my next build. I didn't want to change it until I got through the first round of people kicking the tires.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:18:03**

Fair. Good.

Eric Zelman - **01:18:04**

Yeah.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:18:04**

Okay. Okay.

Eric Zelman - **01:18:06**

So what I'm hopeful is that if I can get, you know, I've got. I don't know, I've got maybe 18 people. My hope is that in about two weeks. I'll have another build based on the feedback of those first testers once they get through it. All right, good, bad, ugly. It sucks. It's useless. It was boring. It crashed. Whatever. It was awesome. Whatever they're gonna say.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:18:30**

So I'll run otter on my phone while I'm going through it, and I'll just comment on it and just create a file and.

Eric Zelman - **01:18:37**

Man, that would be. I mean. Yeah, that's awesome. That or, you know, whisper or whatever, you know, I love that.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:18:42**

That's my favorite. Maybe it's 10 years old now, but I like it. So.

Eric Zelman - **01:18:46**

That would be amazing. I mean, I, like. I don't see. You know, Brendan, I don't say this to everyone I'm testing with, but send me your feedback, and then next time, lunch is on me.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:19:01**

You're fine. We're friends. We got this.

Eric Zelman - **01:19:04**

Oh, and I'm gonna talk to. And I'm. I'm. And I'm gonna. I'm on with Graham at 9:30. Oh, you sound sad. I'm gonna tell him I'm gonna have him test.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:19:16**

Just. It. Just. Just. I just. That's gonna be a long. I mean, we've been on an hour. An hour now, but that's just a long hour with him. And I love him, but I'm like, do something for your happiness,.

Eric Zelman - **01:19:39**

You know? I know, but, like, I. I'm just.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:19:42**

I'm.

Eric Zelman - **01:19:42**

Look, man, I'm excited to get the feedback and.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:19:45**

But he. He'd be ideal because he's looking for a job permanently. So he's like, full time, right?

Eric Zelman - **01:19:50**

Yeah, exactly. So I'm just like, my.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:19:54**

And he's such a.

Eric Zelman - **01:19:55**

My, my, my. Flex in my resumes. Like, I added this whole section, what I'm doing, and they're like, what do you do in your free time? I'm like, I'm. I'm building a company to help me find a job.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:20:07**

So cool. He's such a. I miss him so much. He's such a cool guy.

Eric Zelman - **01:20:14**

All right, all right.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:20:16**

See it. Bye.

Eric Zelman - **01:20:17**

Best to the best, Edith. Bye, too.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:20:19**

Bye. How do I get out of this?

Eric Zelman - **01:20:22**

Bye. Bye.

Brendan McCarthy - **01:20:24**

It.